

Eric Robertson

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Department of Economics
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Citizenship: USA

Academic Positions

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Colgate University July 2026

Education

PhD in Economics, University of Virginia May 2026
Committee: Sheetal Sekhri, Sandip Sukhtankar, Kerem Coşar, Gaurav Chiplunkar
Visiting Research Student, London School of Economics and Political Science 2023, 2024
MA in Economics, University of Virginia Dec. 2021
BA in Economics & Mathematics, University of Virginia May 2017

Fields of Interest

Primary: Development Economics
Secondary: Political Economy, Economic History, Environmental Economics

Working Papers

“Economic Ideas and Policy Implementation: Evidence from Malthusian Training in British Indian Bureaucracy”
Job Market Paper

“The Salt Shock: Scarcity, Substitution, and Surprising Health Spillovers”
(with Sheetal Sekhri, Ramiro Burga, and Sisir Debnath)
Revise and resubmit at the *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*

“Consequences of Elevated Fluoride Exposure for Cognitive Development ”
(with Sheetal Sekhri, Ryan Brown, Amzad Hossain, Emily Gonzalez, and Rajiv Gupta)
Revise and resubmit at the *Journal of Development Economics*

“Competitive Selection and Bureaucrat Performance: Evidence from the end of Patronage in British India”

Work in Progress

“The Long Run Health Consequences of Early-Life Exposure to Fluoride: Evidence from Mexico”
(with Sheetal Sekhri)

Conferences and Presentations

Northeast Universities Development Consortium, Medford, MA November 2025
Washington Area Development Economics Symposium, Washington, DC April 2025
LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar, London, UK May 2024

Teaching Experience

Teaching assistant, UVA:
Environmental Economics (undergraduate) Spring 2025
Economics of the Environment and Sustainability (undergraduate) Fall 2024

<i>Principles of Economics: Macroeconomics (undergraduate)</i>	Summer 2023
<i>Behavioral Finance (undergraduate)</i>	Spring 2022, 2023
<i>Theory of Financial Markets (undergraduate)</i>	Fall 2021, 2022

Fellowships and Awards

Snavely Distinguished Dissertation Award	2026
Jackson-Farrell Graduate Fellowship	2025
Bankard Fund for Political Economy Pre-Doctoral Fellowship	2025
Quantitative Collaborative Bynum Grant	2024
Dumas Malone Graduate Research Fellowship	2023
Tipton R. Snavely Fund Prize for the Best Dissertation Proposal	2023

Research and Other Activities

Student organizer, Bankard Workshop in Development Economics, University of Virginia	2024-2025
Quantitative Collaborative Graduate Student Affiliate	2023-2025
Research Assistant to Professor Sandip Sukhtankar, University of Virginia	2019-2020
Research Assistant to Professor Sheetal Sekhri, University of Virginia	2017-2019

Professional Service

Referee for *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Law and Economics*, *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*

References

Sheetal Sekhri	Sandip Sukhtankar	Kerem Coşar
Professor	Professor	Professor
Dept. of Economics	Dept. of Economics	Dept. of Economics
University of Virginia	University of Virginia	University of Virginia
ssekhi@virginia.edu	srs8yk@virginia.edu	kerem.cosar@virginia.edu